



HTML <!DOCTYPE>

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The HTML Document Type

All HTML documents must start with a [<!DOCTYPE>](#) declaration.

The declaration is not an HTML tag. It is an "information" to the browser about what document type to expect.

In HTML5, the [<!DOCTYPE>](#) declaration is simple:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
```

In older documents (HTML 4 or XHTML), the declaration is more complicated because the declaration must refer to a DTD (Document Type Definition).

```
<!DOCTYPE HTML PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD HTML 4.01 Transitional//EN"  
"http://www.w3.org/TR/html4/loose.dtd">
```

```
<!DOCTYPE html PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD XHTML 1.1//EN"  
"http://www.w3.org/TR/xhtml11/DTD/xhtml11.dtd">
```



Valid HTML Elements in Different DOCTYPES

Tag	HTML 5	HTML 4	XHTML
<u><a></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><abbr></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><acronym></u>	No	Yes	Yes
<u><address></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><applet></u>	No	Yes	No
<u><area></u>	Yes	Yes	No
<u><article></u>	Yes	No	No
<u><aside></u>	Yes	No	No
<u><audio></u>	Yes	No	No
<u></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><base></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><basefont></u>	No	Yes	No
<u><bdi></u>	Yes	No	No
<u><bdo></u>	Yes	Yes	No
<u><big></u>	No	Yes	Yes
<u><blockquote></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><body></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u>
</u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><button></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes
<u><canvas></u>	Yes	No	No
<u><caption></u>	Yes	Yes	Yes



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	CSS	JAVASCRIPT	SQL	PYTHON	JAVA	PHP	W3.CSS	C	C++
<u><code></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><col></u>			Yes		Yes		No		
<u><colgroup></u>			Yes		Yes		No		
<u><data></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><datalist></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><dd></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u></u>			Yes		Yes		No		
<u><details></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><dfn></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><dialog></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><dir></u>			No		Yes		No		
<u><div></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><dl></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><dt></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><embed></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><fieldset></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><figcaption></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><figure></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u></u>			No		Yes		No		
<u><footer></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><form></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><frame></u>			No		Yes		No		



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<u><head></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><header></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><hr></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><html></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><i></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><iframe></u>			Yes		Yes		No		
<u></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><input></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><ins></u>			Yes		Yes		No		
<u><kbd></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><label></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><legend></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><link></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><main></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><map></u>			Yes		Yes		No		
<u><mark></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><meta></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><meter></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><nav></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><noframes></u>			No		Yes		No		
<u><noscript></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><object></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		



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<u><option></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><output></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><p></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><param></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><picture></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><pre></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><progress></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><q></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><rp></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><rt></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><ruby></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><s></u>			Yes		Yes		No		
<u><samp></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><script></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><section></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u><select></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><small></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><source></u>			Yes		No		No		
<u></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><strike></u>			No		Yes		No		
<u></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><style></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		
<u><sub></u>			Yes		Yes		Yes		



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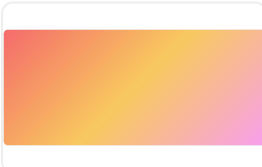
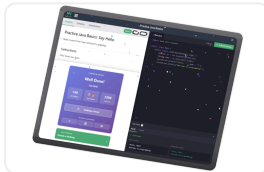


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	CSS	JAVASCRIPT	SQL	PYTHON	JAVA	PHP	W3.CSS	C	C++
<u><table></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><tbody></u>	Yes				Yes		No		
<u><td></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><template></u>	Yes				No		No		
<u><textarea></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><tfoot></u>	Yes				Yes		No		
<u><th></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><thead></u>	Yes				Yes		No		
<u><time></u>	Yes				No		No		
<u><title></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><tr></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><track></u>	Yes				No		No		
<u><tt></u>	No				Yes		Yes		
<u><u></u>	Yes				Yes		No		
<u></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><var></u>	Yes				Yes		Yes		
<u><video></u>	Yes				No		No		
<u><wbr></u>	Yes				No		No		

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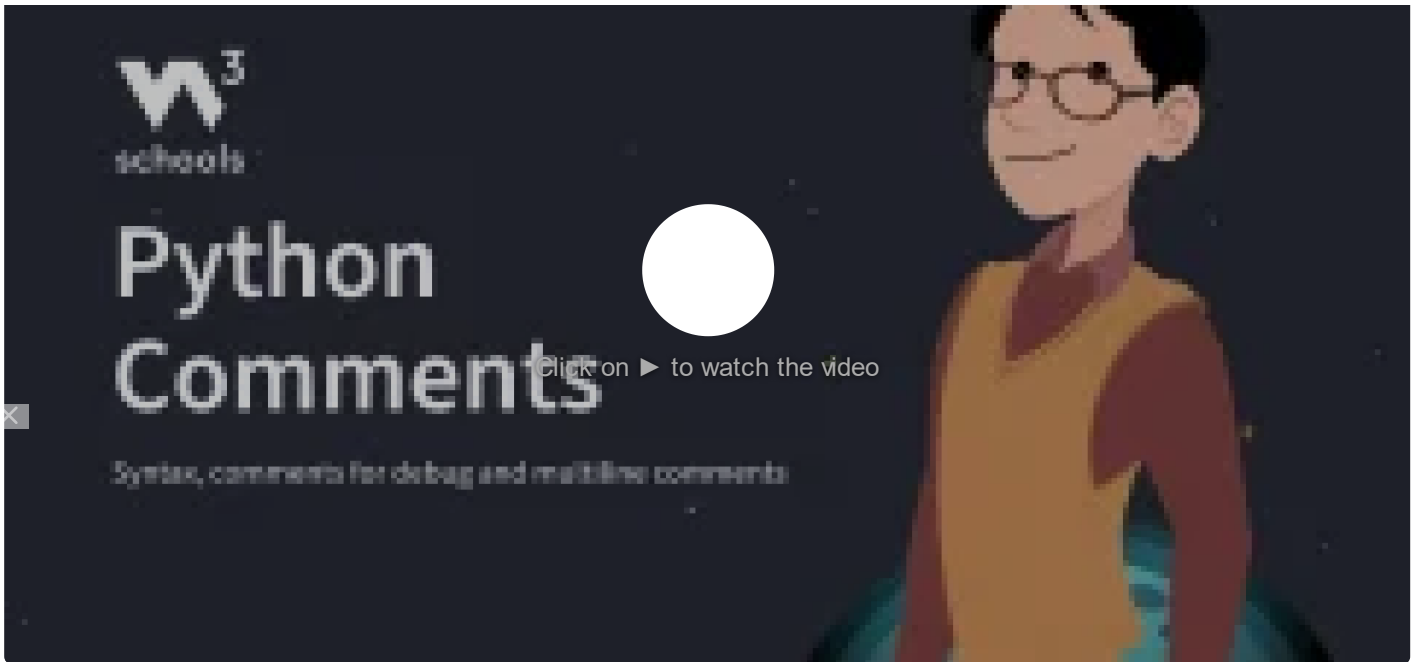
JAVA

PHP

W3.CSS

C

C++



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